INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TACKER, STAPLE (COMPRESSION TYPE, MANUALLY OPERATED FOR ROUND CROWNED STAPLES) AND STAPLE, TACKER (ROUND CROWNED).

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. The staple tacker covered by this specification is of the manually operated compression type for driving 1/4-inch inside width round crown staples. The tacker is used for fastening wire, cable, tubing, etc. onto penetrable materials such as wood, composition board, etc. The tacker staples are of the round crown or nearly round crown types (see figure 1). The staples are of the preformed type, cemented together in strip form, for use in the tackers. Flat topped staples and tackers are covered by Federal Specification GGG-T-20).

1.1.1 Federal specification coverage. Federal specifications do not include all varieties of the commodity as indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those generally used by the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification

1.2.1 Tacker, staple type. The staple tacker covered by this specification shall be of one type for driving 1/4-inch inside width round crown staples, as hereinafter specified.

1.2.2 Staple sizes. The staples covered by this specification shall be of the 1/4-inch inside width round crown type (see figure 1 for sizes) as specified (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and Standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or requests for proposals, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 Boxes, Folding, Paperboard
PPP-B-585 Boxes, Wood, Wire-Bound
PPP-B-591 Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated
PPP-B-601 Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood
PPP-B-621 Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner
PPP-B-636 Box, Fiberboard
PPP-B-640 Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple Wall
PPP-B-665 Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (including Stay Material)
PPP-B-676 Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102 - Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

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Military Specification:

MIL-H-15424 - Hand Tools; Packaging of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Material shall be as hereinafter specified. Material not definitely specified shall be of good commercial quality suitable for the purpose intended. Material shall be free from defects and imperfections which might affect the serviceability of the finished product, and shall meet the performance requirements of this specification.

3.2 Design and Construction. The tackers shall be designed for fastening wire, cable, tubing, etc., to penetrable materials such as wood, composition board, etc., by the use of preformed staples in strip form. The tackers shall perform efficiently when operated with one hand. After each staple is driven to its intended depth, the operating handle shall automatically return to its starting position. The feeding mechanism shall operate automatically so as to feed each successive staple beneath the plunger until the last staple on the strip is used; a positive stop shall be provided to prevent the feeding mechanism from being struck by the staple driver. The tacker shall be either of the jam-free type or be so designed that in the event jamming should occur, the jammed staples can be removed either manually without the aid of hand tools or with a tool furnished by the manufacturer with each tacker. The tacker shall operate with either hand. The tacker shall be capable of driving a staple to within 1/4-inch from a vertical surface at its front and within 7/16-inch at each side. All parts of each make and model of tacker shall be interchangeable, and repair parts shall be made available for Government procurement. Each tacker shall consist essentially of a frame with a handgrip (see 3.2.4), a handle (see 3.2.4), a staple guide (see 3.2.5), a staple follower block and a spring to hold the staples tight, a staple driver (see 3.2.2) attached to a ram or plunger, a spring compressing and actuating mechanism, a vertical chute (see 3.2.6), and fasteners (see 3.2.3).

3.2.1 Springs. Springs shall be made of spring steel and shall be heat-treated in such a manner as to provide for efficient functioning of the tacker. Springs that require attachment to other parts shall be designed to prevent a bending fatigue point which with repeated flexing would tend to rupture the spring.

3.2.2 Staple driver. The staple driver shall be made of spring steel or other comparable steel, and through-hardened to not less than 48 on the Rockwell C scale. The end of the staple driver shall be concaved 1/8-inch to 5/32-inch in depth by 1/4-inch in width at the driving portion.

3.2.3 Fasteners. Except for the handle hinge pin, fasteners shall be made of steel, iron, or brass. The handle hinge pin shall be made of solid steel and shall be not less than 5/32-inch diameter at the bearing surface. Hollow-type fasteners are acceptable.

3.2.4 Handle and handgrip. The handle and handgrip portion of the tool shall be made of steel, iron, or zinc alloy, except that a plastic component may be included as a component of the handgrip. The handle and handgrip shall provide a safe and comfortable grip which shall be smooth, knurled, serrated, rounded, or provided with a cushion grip made of rubber, plastic, or similar material.

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3.2.5 Staple guide. The guide member on which the staples slide into the driving position, shall be made of metal. The width of the guide portion shall be not more than .245 inch so as to accommodate the inside width dimension of staples.

3.2.6 Vertical chute. The surfaces of the vertical chute, through which the staple is guided, shall be made of steel and shall be either through-hardened or case-hardened.

3.3 Surface finish. All surfaces, upon which the staple comes into contact while feeding through, or when being ejected, shall be sufficiently smooth to provide efficient operation.

3.4 Cleaning and applied finish.

3.4.1 Cleaning. All metal surfaces shall be thoroughly cleaned, and free from rust, scale, dirt, oil, grease, moisture, and other material which might affect the finish to be applied.

3.4.2 Coatings . Except for corrosion-resisting metal parts, all exterior metal surfaces shall be either painted or plated. If painted, at least two coats shall be applied in accordance with good commercial practice. The color of the paint shall be the manufacturer's standard. If plated, the plating shall be cadmium, chromium, zinc, or nickel. Plating shall be applied in accordance with good commercial practice.

3.5 Marking. Each tacker and each box of staples shall be marked with the manufacturer's name, or brand name, or trademark, of such known character that the source of manufacture can be readily identified; also the leg length of the staples shall be marked on the box of staples. The tacker marking shall be permanent.

3.6 Tacker. The tacker shall operate efficiently with sizes of staples covered by this specification. The tacker shall accommodate a strip of at least 50 staples. The vertical chute through which the staples are ejected, shall be not less than 0.053 inch, nor more than 0.057 inch in width; and not less than 0.312 inch, nor more than 0.328 inch in length. The height inside the horizontal chute shall be at least 0.533 inch so as to accommodate size 8 staples. The tacking end of the tacker shall have a guide to centralize the tacker on the wire or tube before driving the staple. The guide notch shall be concave in shape, 1/8-inch in depth and 1/4-inch in width. The guide shall extend below the bottom surface of the tacker within 9/64-inch to 5/32 inch so that from the top of the driven staple down to the test lumber shall measure within 1/8 to 5/32 inch. (See section 4) The tacker shall meet the test requirements of section 4.

3.7 Staples. The staples shall be in accordance with the dimensions shown in figure 1. The staples shall be steel wire, preformed to a U-shape, having a round or nearly round top (see fig. 1). The staples shall be cemented together in strip form, each strip consisting of not less than 50 nor more than 86 staples. The cement shall be applied smoothly and shall set in such a manner that the surfaces of the strips shall be free from tackiness. The staple points or ends shall be of such design that the staples will meet the tests in section 4. The steel wire shall be so tempered as to provide penetration of the staple to the intended depth without buckling or fracturing. The staples shall be tinned, galvanized, or made equally corrosion resistant. The staples shall be of the size number (leg length) specified (see fig. 1 and 6.1).

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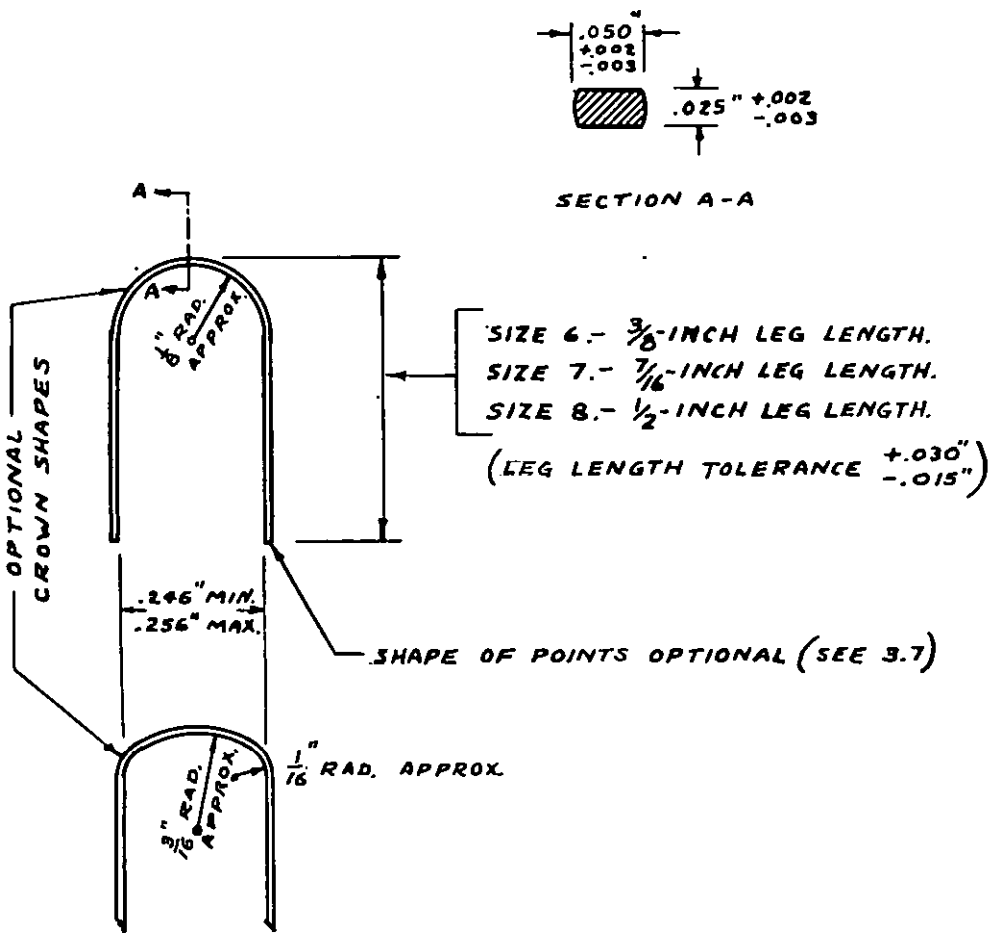


Figure 1. - Staple, tacker.

NOTE: Except for crown shape dimensions, the dimensions apply to both staples shown.

3.8 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class in every respect. The tacker shall be free from burrs, sharp edges, and other defects which might affect safety or serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsibile for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection of materials and components. In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that materials and components used were manufactured, tested and inspected in accordance with requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified herein, or, if none, in accordance with this specification.

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4.2 Sampling for conformance. Sampling shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels shall be in accordance with table I.

Table I. Inspection levels and AQL

Category	Inspection Level	AQL Major	AQL Minor
4.3 Visual and dimensional examination			
Tackers	II	2.5	4.0
Staples (Sample unit is one box)	II	2.5	6.5
4.4 Testing			
Tackers	S - 3	1.0	
Staples (Sample unit is one box)	S - 4	2.5	

4.3 Visual and dimensional examination:

4.3.1 Tackers. Each sample unit shall be examined for defects listed in table II. The acceptable quality level shall be expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. Classification of tacker defects

Categories	Defects
Critical:	None defined.
Major:	
101	Design and size not as specified (see 3.2).
102	Handle does not return automatically to starting position (see 3.2).
103	Feed mechanism does not work automatically (see 3.2).
104	Jammed staples cannot be easily removed (see 3.2).
105	Not capable of driving a staple within 1/4-inch of vertical surface at its front or within 7/16-inch at each side (see 3.2).
106	Springs not designed to prevent a bending fatigue point (see 3.2.1).
107	Handle hinge pin bearing surface less than 5/32-inch diameter (see 3.2.3).
108	Handle and handgrip do not provide a safe and grip (see 3.2.4).
109	The staple guide member is more than 0.245-inch in width (see 3.2.5).
110	The vertical chute through which the staple is guided is unhardened (see 3.2.6).
111	Surface finish not as specified (see 3.3).
112	Does not accommodate a strip of 50 staples (see 3.6).
113	The vertical chute and staple guide are not within the applicable specified dimensions (see 3.6).
114	Materials not as specified.
Minor:	
201	Cleaning not as specified (see 3.4.1).
202	Applied finish not as specified (see 3.4.2).
203	Marking not as specified (see 3.5).

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4.3.2 Staples. Each sample unit shall be examined for defects listed in table III. The acceptable quality level shall be expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE III. - Classification of staple defects

Categories	Defects
Critical:	None defined.
Major:	
101	Staples not of the leg length (size) or other specified dimensions and tolerances (see 1.2.2 and fig. 1).
102	Not cemented together in strips of 50 staples to 86 staples (see 3.7).
103	Staple strips not free from tackiness (see 3.7).
104	Staples not resistant to corrosion (see 3.7).
Minor:	Boxes of staples not marked as specified (see 3.5).

4.4 Testing. The acceptable quality level shall be expressed in terms of percent defective.

4.4.1 Testing of tackers. Each sample unit shall be tested in accordance with 4.5.

4.4.2 Testing of staples. Each sample unit shall be tested in accordance with 4.6.

4.5 Testing of tackers.

4.5.1 Hardness test of staple driver. The staple driver of each sample tacker shall be tested on a Rockwell C scale to determine conformance with 3.2.2.

4.5.2 Performance test for tackers. Each sample tacker shall be tested for performance as follows: A strip of 50 size 8 staples (with 1/2-inch leg length) shall be placed in the tacker, and 50 tacking operations shall be performed by driving the staples into a clear piece of finished Douglas fir lumber having approximately 15 percent moisture content. The tacker shall be held firmly against the test lumber and operated with one hand. The test lumber shall be rigidly supported. At least 47 staples shall be driven to intended penetration; that is, from the top of the driven staple down to the test lumber shall measure within 1/8 to 5/32 inch.

4.6 Performance testing of staples. Each sample box of staples shall be performance tested as follows: One strip of 50 cemented staples shall be removed from sample box. Tacking operations shall be performed with each strip of staples by driving the staples into a clear piece of finished Douglas fir lumber, with the use of a tacker. At least 47 staples from each strip shall be driven to intended penetration without buckling, fracturing, or other defect. The sample strip shall be considered as non-conforming if 47 staples are not driven to intended penetration, that is, from the top of the driven staple down to the test lumber shall measure within 1/8 to 5/32 inch.

4.7 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the preservation, packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification . Defects shall be scored in accordance with table IV. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

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Table IV. Classification of preparation for delivery defects.

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Distortion of container.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging. Preservation and packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging.

5.1.1.1.1 Tacker. The tacker shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with MIL-H-15424 as specified for level A.

5.1.1.1.2 Staples. One thousand staples in strip form (see 3.7) shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665 or PPP-B-676.

5.1.1.1.2.1 Intermediate packaging. Five unit packages of staples shall be packaged together in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, W6c. The box shall be closed and waterproofed sealed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level C. The tackers and staples shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with the suppliers commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Tacker. The tackers shall be packed in accordance with MIL-H-15424 as specified for level A.

5.2.1.2 Staples. Staples of like description in quantities as specified (see 6.1) shall be packed in close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-585, class a, PPP-B-591, class II, PPP-B-601, type III, PPP-B-621, class 2, PPP-B-636, class weather resistant or PPP-B-640, class 2, grade A. The boxes shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the applicable specification or appendix thereto. The gross weight of the triple wall fiberboard box and the wood boxes shall not exceed 200 pounds. The gross weight of the PPP-B-636 fiberboard box shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Tacker. The tackers shall be packed in accordance with MIL-H-15424 as specified for level B.

5.2.2.2 Staples. Staples of like description shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification. The gross weight shall not exceed 65 pounds.

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5.2.3 Level C. The tackers and staples shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Quantity of tackers required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Quantity of boxes of staples required (see 1.1.2 and 5.1).
(d) Leg length of staples required (see figure 1).
(e) Levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) Additional marking, if required (see 5.3).

6.2 Transportation description. Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Tacker, staple:

Rail:

Staplers or tackers, hand.

Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Motor:

Stapling machines (staplers), hand powered.

Truckload minimum weight 24,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

Staple, tacker:

Rail:

Staples, not otherwise indexed by name, galvanized or tinned.

Carload minimum weight 40,000 pounds.

Motor:

Staple, not otherwise indexed, galvanized or tinned.

Truckload minimum weight 40,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

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